

THE STYLING LESSON

The space between

A room is not made only of its objects. It is made just as much of the intervals between them — the bare wall beside the print, the clear stretch of table, the gap on the shelf. *Ma* teaches that these are not absences waiting to be corrected. They are the design.

The test is simple and unforgiving: look at any surface and ask whether the empty parts feel *intended* or merely *unfinished*. An intended emptiness has edges — a margin held on purpose, an object given room to be seen. An accidental one feels like a job half done. The difference is entirely in the restraint: stopping one object sooner than the urge wants you to, and trusting the gap to carry the calm.

"Furnish the objects, then furnish the spaces between them. The second is the harder skill."

